

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX
UNDERGRADUATE ENGLISH LANGUAGE REQUIREMENTS FOR APPLICANTS WHO REQUIRE A STUDENT VISA
(EXCLUDING NATIONALS OF MAJORITY ENGLISH SPEAKING COUNTRIES)

▪ **Overview of English language requirements:**

The English language requirements in this table apply to all students who require a Student visa to study in the UK, excluding nationals of majority English speaking countries (as defined by the [UK Home Office list](#)). The levels are the **minimum** entry requirements for admission to the University.

▪ **Nationals of majority English speaking countries:**

If you are a National of a majority English speaking country (as defined by the [UK Home Office list](#)) please see <https://www1.essex.ac.uk/documents/admissions/englishheu.pdf>

▪ **Test Validity/shelf life**

For all the tests listed in this table, except IELTS, Pearson Test of English (PTE) Academic and TOEFL, we can accept a test taken **up to 5 years** before the start of the course you are applying for at Essex. For October 2026 entry an acceptable English language qualification would need to have been achieved in June 2021 or more recently.

- **IELTS:** valid for 3 years (taken in October 2023 or more recently). Must be verifiable online by the University
- **PTE Academic:** valid for **3 years (taken in June 2023 or more recently)**. Must be verifiable online by the University at the point that any offer is made
- **TOEFL:** valid for **2 years (taken in June 2024 or more recently)**. Must be verifiable online by the University at the point that any offer is made

▪ **Combining scores from two tests**

We can accept a combination of two tests of the same type (e.g., two IELTS tests) providing both the overall and all component scores are met across the two tests, and both were taken within the accepted validity period/ shelf life for that test.

▪ **Approved test centres and dates:**

All the tests below are acceptable and, for study at degree-level, these tests can be taken at any test centre, not just approved UKVI test centres.

For courses below degree-level (Certificates of Higher Education in Acting for Stage and Screen (W410) and Technical Theatre and Production Arts (W413) please see additional requirements specified in the table below relating to approved test centres and the date your test was taken.

For more details of Home Office requirements, please see the information [here](#).

▪ **Courses with different English language requirements than those listed in this table:**

- **Dental Hygiene, Dental Hygiene and Therapy, Nursing, Social Work, Physiotherapy, Occupational Therapy and Speech and Language Therapy** - More information can be found in our English language requirements for applicants to Health and Social Care (HSC) courses: <https://www1.essex.ac.uk/documents/admissions/hscleltsAndEquivalents.pdf>

▪ **English qualifications or tests not listed in the table:**

If you are taking an English language qualification that is not specified below, please email ugquery@essex.ac.uk for advice on whether it is acceptable for entry.

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<u>Pre-Sessional English (PSE) course at the University of Essex</u>	Pre-Sessional English courses are designed to improve your English language level ahead of studying at degree-level at the University of Essex. If you do not meet the IELTS requirements then you may be able to take a Pre-Sessional English pathway that enables you to meet our English language requirements without retaking IELTS. Our courses We offer a range of <u>Pre-Sessional English Language (PSE)</u> courses delivered by expert teachers at the <u>University of Essex International College (UEIC)</u>, a Kaplan International Pathways partner. Please see <u>our website</u> for further information. Validity period/shelf-life Our Pre-Sessional English courses are normally only valid for entry to a main course which starts immediately after the Pre-Sessional course. If you take a Pre-Sessional English course but then are not able to start your main course in October, the Pre-Sessional course will not normally remain valid. If we can offer you a later start date for your main course, we may ask you for an alternative proof of your English language proficiency. Application deadline After mid-June our PSE courses will all have closed to applications - please see <u>our website</u> for further information. Course exclusions For entry to courses that are below-degree level – the Certificate of Higher Education in Acting for Stage and Screen (W410) or Technical Theatre and Production Arts - you will need a UKVI Secure English Language test, so our PSE courses are not suitable. Acceptability of other universities Pre-Sessional English courses We do not routinely accept Pre-Sessional English courses taken at other UK universities.
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English Language test/qualification (Listed in alphabetical order)	Minimum Level required See the first page for information about your test date and the validity period/shelf life of your test			
	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
British Academic Centre International English Test (BACIET)	Not acceptable	5.5 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component	6.0 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component	6.5 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component
Cambridge English Qualifications: C1 Advanced (Certificate in Advanced English) Or C2 Proficiency (Certificate of Proficiency in English)	Not acceptable	A score of 162 overall on the Cambridge English Scale, with a minimum of 162 in each component	A score of 169 overall on the Cambridge English Scale, with a minimum of 162 in each component	A score of 176 overall on the Cambridge English Scale, with a minimum of 162 in each component

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
GCSE/ IGCSE/Cambridge O-Level English (as a first or second language) Excluding IGCSE Pearson Edexcel English Language as a Second Language (see below)	Not acceptable	Grade C or 4	Grade C or 4	Grade C or 4
IGCSE Pearson Edexcel English Language as a Second Language	Not acceptable	Grade 7	Grade 7	Grade 7

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
IELTS (Academic) IELTS Online (Academic) IELTS (Academic) One Skill Retake IELTS Indicator	UKVI IELTS (Academic only) 5.0 overall with a minimum of 4.0 in each component Must be a UKVI IELTS taken at an approved IELTS test centre on the UKVI's list, available here , Test must be taken within two years of the start of your course.	5.5 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component	6.0 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component	6.5 overall with a minimum of 5.5 in each component
International Baccalaureate	Not acceptable	Standard Level or Higher Level grade 4 in any of the below modules: English A: Language and Literature English A: Literature English B English Literature and Performance	Standard Level or Higher Level grade 4 in any of the below modules: English A: Language and Literature English A: Literature English B English Literature and Performance	Standard Level or Higher Level grade 4 in any of the below modules: English A: Language and Literature English A: Literature English B English Literature and Performance

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
KTE (Kaplan Test of English) Kaplan Digital Pre-Sessional English or Kaplan Digital Pre-Sessional English Plus	Not acceptable	396 with no less than 396 in any component	426 with no less than 396 in any component	459 with no less than 396 in any component
LanguageCert Academic SELT LanguageCert Academic (when taken at a test centre)	LanguageCert Academic SELT only 55 overall with a minimum of 45 in each component Tests must be taken at an approved test centre on the UKVI's list , to be accepted for below degree-level courses. Test must be taken within two years of the start of your course.	60 overall with a minimum of 60 in each component	65 overall with a minimum of 60 in each component	70 overall with a minimum of 60 in each component

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
Michigan English Test – Examination for the Certificate of Proficiency in English (ECPE)	Not acceptable	Successful completion of the ECPE Certificate of Proficiency with Pass overall to include 700 in each component.	Successful completion of the ECPE Certificate of Proficiency with Pass overall to include 750 in each component.	Successful completion of the ECPE Certificate of Proficiency with Pass overall to include 795 in each component
Oxford International Digital Institute Online Pre-sessional English Course (OPSE) and Online English Language Level Test (ELLT) / ELLT Global	Not acceptable	Overall B2 with B2 in each component Or 5 overall with 5 in each component	Overall B2+ with B2 in each component Or 6 overall with 5 in each component	Overall C1 with B2 in each component Or 7 overall with 5 in each component
Oxford Test of English – Certificate of Proficiency	Not acceptable	111 overall including a minimum of 111 in each component	126 overall including a minimum of 111 in each component	140 overall including a minimum of 111 in each component

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
Pearson Test of English Academic We do not accept PTE online	PTE Academic UKVI only 50 overall, with a minimum of 43 in each component. Tests must be taken at an approved test centre on the UKVI's list , to be accepted for below degree-level courses. Test must be taken within two years of the start of your course	59 overall, with a minimum of 59 in each component	60 overall, with a minimum of 59 in each component	62 overall, with a minimum of 59 in each component
Skills for English: SELT	B1 Pass Tests must be taken at an approved test centre on the UKVI's list , to be accepted for below degree-level courses. Test must be taken within two years of the start of your course	B2 Pass	B2 Pass with Merit	B2 Pass with Merit

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	Below degree-level courses	Degree-level courses (excluding courses with non-standard requirements)		
	Certificate of Higher Education	Foundation Year	First Year entry	Second and Final Year Direct Entry
TOEFL (iBT) TOEFL iBT Online – Special Home Edition TOEFL – My Best Scores	Not acceptable	Tests taken on or after 21 January 2026: 4 overall with a minimum of 4 in each component Tests taken before 21 January 2026: 72 overall, with a minimum of 18 in reading, 17 in listening, 20 in speaking and 17 in writing	Tests taken on or after 21 January 2026: 4 overall with a minimum of 4 in each component Tests taken before 21 January 2026: 82 overall, with a minimum of 18 in reading, 17 in listening, 20 in speaking and 17 in writing	Tests taken on or after 21 January 2026: 4 overall with a minimum of 4 in each component Tests taken before 21 January 2026: 91 overall, with a minimum of 18 in reading, 17 in listening, 20 in speaking and 17 in writing
Trinity College London Integrated Skills in English (ISE) Level III and IV	Pass (overall and in each component) Tests must be taken at an approved test centre on the UKVI's list , to be accepted for below degree-level courses. Test must be taken within two years of the start of your course	Pass (overall and in each component)	Pass (overall and in each component)	Pass (overall and in each component)

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